IMPARTING HOLISTIC, VALUE BASED EDUCATION



DR ALAM A. SISODIA
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Dr. Alam A. Sisodia is a highly regarded legal consultant and the General Secretary of Vidya Bharati School. His significant contributions to education have brought about positive changes, enhancing the lives of students. He has revolutionized the education sector by advocating for holistic education that combines academic excellence, personal development, and values-based learning. Dr. Sisodia's leadership serves as a testament to the transformative power of hard work and dedication.

What is your observation on the current milieu in the education sector and its evolving challenges?

In today's 21st century, it has become essential to acquire the right skill sets that allow us to effectively apply and utilize that knowledge. Moreover, having the right attitude is crucial to thrive in our ever-evolving world. Success now hinges on our willingness to unlearn what we know and embrace new learning experiences to the fullest.

In this day and age, the primary goal of education should be fostering the development of a learning community that can adapt and navigate through the constantly changing landscape. It's all about creating an environment where individuals can collectively reshape their paths and stay ahead in this dynamic scenario.

How is Vidya Bharati providing a beyond classroom experience to its students?

At Vidya Bharati, education surpasses traditional textbooks and classrooms. We integrate the virtual world into our learning environment through interactive touch panels and high-end computers. Learning transcends physical boundaries and embraces digital platforms. We encourage our students to harness the power of digital media, including social media, as a valuable learning tool.

According to the Redseer report, Indians spend an average of 7.3 hours on their phones each day, surpassing both Americans and Chinese. We capitalize on this opportunity by advising students to watch educational videos and read articles before and after classes, effectively extending their learning experience. Vidya Bharati combines conventional teaching methods with digital resources to foster a comprehensive and captivating educational atmosphere.

How is your school's vision and mission aligned with the new concept of education focused on skill orientation?

Our mission is to empower students to acquire and demonstrate valuable knowledge, skills, and values, enabling them to become lifelong learners who actively participate in and contribute to the global community. This mission explains our commitment to providing a skill-oriented education.

To ensure the best of both textbook knowledge and practical knowledge, what initiatives has your school taken?

We believe in providing students with a well-rounded education that combines textbook knowledge with practical learning experiences. To achieve this, we have implemented various initiatives. Our textbooks now incorporate practical aspects of learning, ensuring a comprehensive educational experience. Additionally, we offer a range of practical resources such as School Radio, a Digital Video Channel, Robotics, Social Science, Maths, and Digital Art and Animation Laboratories. These resources provide hands-on experimentation opportunities, complementing our textbook teachings.

A sound body, a sound mind are essentials for healthy growth of young children. What efforts have you made in this direction?

We have revamped our games and sports strategy by bringing around 250 children of the same age group together for 90 minutes under the guidance of expert coaches. Each game has two teams that regularly play matches with the children. Our approach focuses on developing skills beyond physical exercise, including teamwork, alertness, decision-making, and cooperation. Through these efforts, we aim to promote the healthy growth of young minds and nurture qualities essential for success.

How have you leveraged technology for smart classes and smart learning?

By integrating technology, we have created dynamic learning environments in our classrooms. Smart classes enable interactive and multimedia-rich teaching methods, enhancing the learning experience. This approach fosters engagement, interactivity, and provides access to a wide range of educational resources. As a result, our students develop essential digital skills and adapt to the evolving technological landscape.

What are the criteria while hiring faculty at your school?

We believe that teachers play a crucial role beyond teaching their assigned subjects. We seek hardworking, organized, team-oriented, and inquisitive individuals, preferably young learners, who are eager to embrace the art of teaching. Our school employs a rigorous selection process to ensure that our teachers, whom we refer to as mentors, inspire our students to become lifelong learners.

Could you share about parent-teacher rapport essential for a child's growth?

We have developed a unique parent connect program that invites the entire family of each child to spend a day in the classroom. From the morning prayer to regular classes, parents remain with their child, gaining a first-hand understanding of the efforts made by our mentors and experiencing the hands-on learning taking place in our school. We highly value parents and recognize their involvement as one of the most valuable resources for enhancing the skills and growth of our learners.

The way forward to create children of tomorrow?

Inspired by the wisdom of author Kahlil Gibran, we firmly believe that children will blossom in the house of tomorrow, beyond our own imagination and even in our wildest dreams. Therefore, we place a strong emphasis on character development, equipping children with essential skills, fostering the right attitude, and nurturing resilience. We strive to prepare them to embrace any challenges that come their way, ensuring they are well-prepared to navigate the ever-changing landscape of life.